Chiara Gambardella, PhD

Marine ecologist · **Postdoctoral Researcher**, Queen's University Belfast

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POSITIONS

2026-present — **Postdoctoral Researcher**, PEACEPLUS MOSAIC project, Queen's University Belfast, School of Biological Sciences, Queen's Marine Station, Portaferry
Habitat associations of OSPAR-listed elasmobranchs and critical habitat of target species (flapper skate) in Irish and Northern Irish waters; AUV and BRUV surveys.

2026-present — **Marine Scientist & Educator**, EYOS Expeditions
Design and delivery of on-board marine science programmes (visual census, citizen science, eDNA, water quality, science education).

2021-present — **Field operator & project assistant**, White Shark Chase, Ferretti Lab, Virginia Tech
Four expeditions (2021, 2022, 2023, 2025): pelagic BRUV design and deployment, eDNA sampling and on-board DNA analysis, satellite tagging, video analysis.

2022 — **Research Fellow**, Stazione Zoologica Anton Dohrn, Palermo (SharkNoise and BOSE projects)
Pelagic and benthic stereo-BRUVs, underwater acoustic recorders, video and spectrogram analysis.

2022 — **National Observer for bluefin tuna and swordfish** (ICCAT monitoring), Oceanis s.r.l.

EDUCATION

2022-2026 — **PhD in Life and Environmental Sciences, Doctor Europaeus**, Università Politecnica delle Marche and Stazione Zoologica Anton Dohrn. Outstanding cum laude
Ecology and population connectivity of lamnid sharks in the Mediterranean Sea. Supervisors: C. Cerrano, T. Romeo, F. Colloca, F. Ferretti. Research visits: Museo Nacional de Ciencias Naturales, Madrid (2025); Instituto de Ciencias del Mar, Barcelona (2024); Virginia Tech (2023).

2018-2021 — **MSc in Marine Biology**, Università Politecnica delle Marche. 110/110 summa cum laude
Population assessment and trophic relationships of batoids in the North Adriatic Sea.

2014-2018 — **BSc in Biology**, Università Politecnica delle Marche

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

10 peer-reviewed articles, 7 under review or submitted. Full list: ORCID and Google Scholar.

[1] **Gambardella C**, Giannelli F, Fernández-Corredor E, et al. (2026). Evidence of genetic continuity in the shortfin mako shark (*Isurus oxyrinchus*) between the Eastern Atlantic and Mediterranean basins. *Ecology and Evolution*. doi:10.1002/ece3.73261

[2] **Gambardella C**, Fernández-Corredor E, Moro S, et al. (2025). Trophic niche partitioning between the white shark (*Carcharodon carcharias*) and the shortfin mako (*Isurus oxyrinchus*) in the central Mediterranean Sea. *Wildlife Research* 52, WR25028. doi:10.1071/WR25028

[3] Smith SDG, Dorrian-Smith MA, Ferreira GSNR, **Gambardella C**, et al. Chronic sublethal injury in a critically endangered flapper skate (*Dipturus intermedius*): in situ evidence consistent with trawl capture. *Aquaculture, Fish and Fisheries*. doi:10.1002/aff2.70361

[4] Ferretti F, Shea B, **Gambardella C**, et al. (2024). On the tracks of white sharks in the Mediterranean Sea. *Frontiers in Marine Science* 11. doi:10.3389/fmars.2024.1425511

[5] Shea BD, Chapple TK, Echwikhi K, **Gambardella C**, et al. (2024). First satellite track of a juvenile shortfin mako shark (*Isurus oxyrinchus*) in the Mediterranean Sea. *Frontiers in Marine Science* 11. doi:10.3389/fmars.2024.1423507

[6] Jenrette J, Truelove K, Moro S, et al., **Gambardella C**, et al. (2023). Detecting Mediterranean white sharks with environmental DNA. *Oceanography*. doi:10.5670/oceanog.2023.s1.28

[7] Cattano C, **Gambardella C**, Grancagnolo D, et al. (2023). Multiple interannual records of young-of-the-year identify an important area for the protection of the shortfin mako, *Isurus oxyrinchus*. *Marine Environmental Research* 192, 106217

[8] **Gambardella C**, Dorrian-Smith MA, Glynn F, Smith SDG, Collins PC. Life history as a limit to exploitability: the case of the critically endangered flapper skate. *Under review, JMBA*

[9] **Gambardella C**, Moro S, Panunzi G, et al. Integrating opportunistic records to model spatio-temporal abundance of shortfin mako sharks in the Mediterranean Sea. *Under review, Diversity and Distributions*

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 Sharks International, Colombo, Sri Lanka (talk) · MASTS Annual Science Meeting, Glasgow (ePoster)

2025 European Elasmobranch Association Conference, Rotterdam (talk)

2024 ICES Annual Science Conference, Gateshead (talk)

GRANTS & AWARDS

2026 Fisheries Society of the British Isles Travel Grant

2025 Flying Sharks Stingray Fund

2025 Save Our Seas Foundation & EEA Travel Bursary

2025 Erasmus Traineeship, UNIVPM

2024 SZN BEOM Travel Grant Fellowship

2022 American Elasmobranch Society Young Professional Recruitment Fund

2021 Campus World Scholarship, UNIVPM

SERVICE

2024- Co-Chair, Conservation Committee, Europe & Mediterranean Council, and IGFA Representative, International Game Fish Association

TEACHING & SUPERVISION

Teaching assistant at UNIVPM in Zoology, Statistics and Fishery Management (2019-2026, about 290 h)

Mentor of MSc students, University of Gabès, on shark genetics (2023-present)

Supervisor of 3 IMBRSea MSc professional practices (2021, 2023, 2024)

OUTREACH

13 public talks, panels and trainings since 2021, including *The future of the Mediterranean Sea* (CIESM, Monaco, 2026), recreational fisheries training for elementary schools (Pescare Show, 2025 and 2026), and a live interview on Mediterranean white sharks for BBC News (2025). Collaborator of sharkPulse Italia (citizen science).

SKILLS

`field` Stereo-BRUV design, calibration and video analysis · eDNA sampling · tagging expeditions for large pelagic animals · underwater acoustic recorders · non-lethal sampling and biometrics

`lab` DNA extraction, quantification and amplification · ddRAD library preparation · stable isotopes ($\delta^{13}C$, $\delta^{15}N$)

`analysis` R, Python, INLA · species distribution and spatio-temporal models · population genomics (Stacks, BayeScan, Arlequin) · QGIS · LaTeX, Git, Bash

References available on request.